

Müller's gibbon

Hylobates muelleri

The smallest members of the ape family, gibbons are among the most acrobatic primates, able to bridge gaps of more than 33 ft (10 m) between trees by flinging themselves across with their long arms. Müller's gibbon is one of four gibbon species native to Borneo, where it inhabits tall rainforest and tropical forest canopies. Since it rarely comes down to the ground, this species is mainly threatened by loss of habitat due to forest clearance.

While touch and grooming play vital roles in other ape species, gibbons bond and communicate largely by vocalizing, or "singing," and each species has its own unique song. Adults are serial monogamists, and mated pairs defend their territory with morning duets. The male begins singing shortly before dawn and is joined by the female after sunrise for an average of 15 minutes, before the daily search for food begins.

Gibbons use the same **vocalization techniques as operatic sopranos**

arms one-and-a-half times as long as legs



- ↔ 16–25 in (41–64 cm)
- ⚖ 10–16 lb (4.5–7.3 kg)
- ⊗ Endangered
- 🍌 Ripe fruit, leaves, flowers
- 🏠 🌳 🌿



SE. Asia (Borneo)

◀ KING OF THE SWINGERS

Gibbons are highly agile and move by brachiation, or arm-swinging, traveling through trees at speeds of up to 34 mph (55 km/h).

Common flying dragon

Draco volans

Rather than flying like its mythical namesake, this lizard glides between tree trunks to find food or mates, or to avoid territorial conflicts or predators. Its wings consist of stretchy skin supported by elongated ribs. Common flying dragon glides have been measured at more than 33 ft (10 m), with anecdotal records exceeding 165 ft (50 m). When not airborne, the wings are folded along the sides of the body for protection. They also aid camouflage, both with their coloration and by disrupting the typical body shape of a lizard. The dragon's favorite foods are tree ants and termites, usually caught morning and evening.

Mating displays

At breeding time the territorial male head-bobs, unfurls his wings, and fans out his bright yellow dewlap (chin flap) to repel rival males and attract females. After mating, the female climbs down to the ground and digs a shallow hole with her snout for her eggs.

▷ CONTROLLED GLIDE

As it glides, the dragon's chest muscles extend and tilt the ribs to curve the wings for lift, if air currents allow, and for directional control, aided by the tail and feet.

- ↔ 6–8 in (15–20 cm)
- ⚖ $\frac{3}{16}$ – $\frac{3}{8}$ oz (5–10 g)
- ⊗ Common
- 🍌 Ants, termites, small insects
- 🏠 🌳 🌿



SE. Asia

